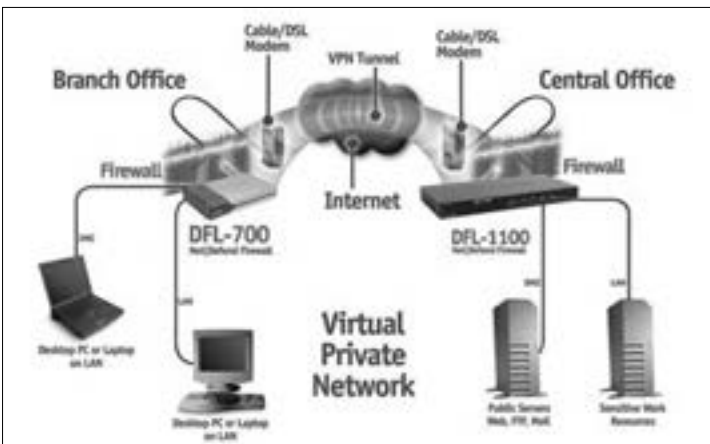


An application layer firewall, as the name suggests, works on the application level of the TCP/IP stack. This is to say that it works on all browser traffic or all telnet or ftp traffic. It may also intercept all packets travelling to or from an application. In principle, application firewalls can prevent all unwanted outside traffic from reaching protected machines.

Finally, depending on the state of traffic packets, there exists stateful or stateless firewalls.

‘A stateful firewall can hold in memory significant attributes of each connection. These attributes, collectively known as the state of the connection, may include details such as the IP addresses. A processor-intensive checking is performed at the time of setup of the connection. All packets after that are processed rapidly because it is simple and fast to determine whether it belongs to an existing, pre-screened session.

‘A stateless firewall treats each packet of information in isolation, and there is no way by which it could know if the packet is part of a larger set or just a rogue packet.



A virtual private network set protected by a firewall